Tarzan

By Wayne Rice and Mike Yaconelli

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

This skit takes place "in the jungle," of course. As it opens, Tarzan's boy companion, Jive, is tied to a pole, ready to be burned at the stake.

Characters:

- *Tarzan* - ***Actor 1***
- *Colonel Grub, the villain* - ***Actor 2***
- *Chief* – ***Actor 2***
- *Jive, Tarzan's boy companion* – ***Actor 2***
- *Tenderbelly, the chief's daughter* – ***Actor 2***
- *Narrator* – ***Actor 1***

NARRATOR: Darkest Africa! Wild and foreboding! Man-killing beasts stalk their prey in these dark jungles, ready at any moment to spring, tear, and mangle. Wild savages lurk in dense underbrush waiting to ambush unwary travelers. So sit right back and relax, as we present "Tarzan."

INTRODUCTION

TOGETHER: *Tarzan by Wayne Rice and Mike Yaconelli*

COLONEL: *(to audience)* Hi, there! I'm the villain in tonight's episode! So far, I've burned down the village of the Lumbago Tribe, I've captured Tarzan's little friend Jive, and, worst of all, I've said nasty things to the animals! But, so far, Tarzan hasn't shown up!

TARZAN: *(Tarzan enters, swinging on a rope if possible, and yelling.)* AHHH ... EEEEE ...

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AHHH ... EEEEE ... AHHH ... WAAYA!

COLONEL: Oh-Oh! That's Tarzan now! *(to Tarzan)* Me Colonel Grub! You Tarzan! Tarzan want boy to live? Tarzan listen to me! Me Boss! You Slave! Savvy?

TARZAN: Tell me, Colonel, have you had this speech problem all your life?

COLONEL: Why-Why, you speak as good as me!

TARZAN: Wrong again, Colonel! That's "as well as I." And I happen to speak ***better*** than you.

COLONEL: But when did all this happen? What happened to your English?

TARZAN: Well, Jane isn't with me any longer, so I spend my evenings brushing up on my English!

COLONEL: Well, good English or bad English, the situation remains the same! Either you take orders from me or the boy dies!

TARZAN: Big deal! I hardly know the kid! *(Chief enters.)*

CHIEF: Ungowah! Tarzan in big trouble! Tarzan burn down village of Lumbagos!

TARZAN: I didn't burn down your village!

CHIEF: We put Tarzan in cobra pit. If Tarzan speak truth, cobra will not kill!

TARZAN: Cobra pit? Isn't it enough if I say, "Cross my heart and hope to die?"

COLONEL: What are you afraid of, Tarzan? I've heard that you're the friend of a million jungle animals!

TARZAN: I am! Unfortunately, there are a million and a half in this jungle! Besides, it was probably you who burned this village.

COLONEL: Maybe! But how are you going to prove it?

TARZAN: With my knowledge of the jungle, it would be easy to follow footprints, search for matches and gasoline in your tent, investigate ashes ...

COLONEL: Resorting to evidence, eh? The 'oldest trick in the book! But it won't

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work among these savages! They believe in the judgment of the cobra! So into the pit!

TARZAN: What are you going to do with the boy?

CHIEF: He stay tied up! Any friend of Tarzan's no friend of ours!

TARZAN: That's unfair! Why not put the kid in with the cobra and tie me up to the tree?

JIVE: Tarzan! How can you talk like that! I've been at your side every waking moment for the past nine years!

TARZAN: Which is precisely why I'm talking like this!

CHIEF: Enough! Into the pit! *(Tarzan exits.)*

NARRATOR: Once in the pit, our fearless hero gains the friendship of the cobra, once more proving that all jungle animals love Tarzan. *(Tarzan enters with snake over shoulder.)*

CHIEF: Ancient tribal code say, since Tarzan make friend with cobra, Tarzan must be telling truth!

COLONEL: Hold on, Chief! I wanted Tarzan to help me trap elephants for ivory! But I don't need him! Your tribe can help me instead! Follow my orders and I'll make you rich!

CHIEF: However, modern tribal code say, since you offer us good deal, ancient tribal code don't stand a chance! We follow!

TARZAN: Don't do it, Chief! Don't you see this man's intentions are dubious, insidious, and furtive?!

COLONEL: And my first order as your leader is to kill the loinclothed Noah Webster!

TARZAN: Stop! After years of companionship and understanding, you can't kill me like that! You aren't that savage!

CHIEF: Right! We must repay him for his kindness! Count to five ... then kill!

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NARRATOR: Tarzan, realizing that he is doomed, proceeds to bellow out one of his famous earsplitting jungle cries . . . this momentarily deafens those around him, enabling him to flee to freedom among the familiar jungle surroundings. *(Tarzan flees.)*

COLONEL: Well, Jive! It looks like your friend Tarzan isn't coming back to help you! Any last requests?

JIVE: Yes! Would you please remove my draft card from my pocket before you light the fire? I don't want to get into trouble for burning my draft card.

TARZAN: *(Spying on the Colonel)* Now to see what Colonel Grub is up to! Holy ant hills! They're going to burn Jive at the stake! If I didn't have laundry to do I'd rescue him! Wait a minute! Jive does my laundry! Darn! Now I've got to save him! *(Tarzan unsheathes his knife and enters to confront the Colonel)* O.K., Colonel! Drop the gun!

CHIEF: O.K., Tarzan! Drop the knife!

COLONEL: You'll be sorry you came back, Tarzan! O.K., Chief! Run him through!

TARZAN: Wait, Chief! I appeal to you!

CHIEF: Sorry! Tarzan do not appeal to me! Not even in that miniskirt!

TENDERBELLY: *(Tenderbelly enters)* Wait! Stop! Spare Tarzan's life! Kill me instead!

TARZAN: Tenderbelly! You're the Chief's daughter! Why do you want to save my life!

TENDERBELLY: Because Tarzan teach me how to love, kiss, and make out!

TARZAN: Tenderbelly! Please! Don't say another word!

TENDERBELLY: Tenderbelly's big heart say Tarzan must live!

TARZAN: Yeah ... but Tenderbelly's big mouth say Tarzan must die.

CHIEF: Enough fooling around! We settle this mess with big fight to finish! If Tarzan loses and is killed, then he must be put to death!

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TARZAN: Your sentence structure is a trifle redundant, Chief! Grammatically speaking the proper phrasing should be ...

CHIEF: Hold your filthy tongue in front of the maiden! Have you no respect for an innocent girl? The iron tooth will show the truth!

TARZAN: You mean that knife will decide my life?!

COLONEL: Enough dumb rhyme! You're wasting time! *(Tenderbelly shoots the Colonel.)*

TENDERBELLY: The job is done! I used the gun!

CHIEF: One more poem and I go home!

TARZAN: Tenderbelly! How could you kill him like that?

TENDERBELLY: I knew you couldn't! You too chicken! Besides, after you spare him, he turn around and stab you in back!

CHIEF: Tenderbelly speak the truth! I was blinded by promises of wealth! But now, Colonel Grub is dead, and Tarzan lives! Tarzan do another show next week! And week after that! And summer reruns! Chief no fool! He know which side of bread to butter up! *(Chief exits.)*

JIVE: *(Jive enters, running)* Tarzan, I'm free! They set me free!

TARZAN: Well, I can console myself with the knowledge that there will always be other villains willing to kill a kid!

JIVE: What can I do to repay you for saving my life?

TARZAN: Just a simple token of appreciation will be enough! Like a whalebone slingshot!

JIVE: But the nearest whales are millions of miles from here ... in the Arctic!

TARZAN: Dress warmly, kid! As for you, Tenderbelly ... I think we should continue your lessons! *(Tarzan and Tenderbelly exit.)*

NARRATOR: So as Tarzan and Tenderbelly frolic through the underbrush together, we come to the end of tonight's [today's] episode of ... TARZAN!

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